

"iQOO 16 will be our most complete flagship yet"

Such is **Nipun Marya**'s confidence

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The intense competition in the Indian smartphone market forced almost every player to box themselves into predictable categories: the camera-centric device, the ultra-slim lifestyle statement, or a gaming unit. For years, iQOO firmly occupied the latter territory. Until now.

iQOO is signaling an evolution. In an exclusive interview, iQOO India CEO Nipun Marya showcased the brand's upcoming flagship phone - iQOO 16 - but at the same time, promised that this is the most complete, balanced flagship smartphone the company has ever engineered.

"This time there is going to be a surprise for anybody who's looking at a flagship... it's no more about only performance or performance centric; I think we are making the most complete flagship we have ever made when it comes to iQOO flagships," Nipun claimed.

Sporting two distinct colours the device immediately commands attention with its design. It presents a sophisticated, streamlined profile suitable for any boardroom. However, tilt the device under changing light, and it transforms revealing subtle streaks of colour, dynamic light reflections, and an edgy character.

The phone is confirmed to run on the Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 6 Extreme platform, which at this point, is the world's fastest mobile platform. But Marya was quick to emphasise that the hardware story goes far deeper than raw processing.

For years, iQOO's critics and fans alike acknowledged a familiar trade-off: you bought an iQOO for the silicon and stayed for the speed, while the camera system often played second fiddle. Marya addresses this candidly.

"You will see that on the camera like I mentioned earlier as well... hardware side, software side, performance especially – performance when you come to low light and high action scenes, you will see that the performance of iQOO 16 is going to exceed your expectations," he said.

The phone adopts a formidable 50-megapixel triple-camera array (50MP + 50MP + 50MP). On the visual front, the device houses the advanced M16 display, which Marya describes as one of the most sophisticated panels ever integrated into a phone.

The software evolution

Hardware prowess is only half the battle, software integration dictates daily usability. Last year marked a major milestone for the brand when it introduced OriginOS to the Indian market following persistent user demand for some time.

With the launch of OriginOS 7, iQOO is doubling down on refinements derived directly from Indian consumer feedback. The new software layer introduces expansive customisation options designed to make each device deeply personal and distinct.

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